

Small-Group Discussion Guide

From Justification toward Sanctification · Six sessions · NLT

Each meeting: opening Scripture · discussion · practice report · closing prayer. Depth matters more than covering every question.

Session 1 – The Gap (Chapters 1–2)

Opening: Read James 1:23–25. Sit in silence ten seconds before anyone speaks.

1. When have you known the right thing and still could not do it in the moment?
2. How would you explain “word alignment” without repeating jargon?
3. Where is your church strong at transmission, and weaker at transformation?
4. Marcus taught Galatians 5 and lost his temper an hour later — irony, hypocrisy, or something more ordinary?

Practice report: Three-second pause before responding this week.

Prayer: Eyes to see the gap without despair or excuse.

Session 2 – Four Diagnoses (Chapters 3–6)

Opening: Recap: hearing ≠ growing; grace ≠ permission; training ≠ unspiritual; justification ≠ the whole journey.

1. Where do we confuse a good lesson with actual growth? (James 1:22–25)
2. How does grace that “instructs” (Titus 2:11–12) differ from how you learned grace?
3. Which has your formation emphasized more — justification or sanctification — and what has that produced?
4. Walk 2 Peter 1:5–9 link by link. Which link feels weakest in the room?

Practice report: The sentence What will I do differently? — did you do it?

Prayer: Courage for one small step in a plateaued relationship.

Session 3 – Inner Territory (Chapters 7–8)

Opening: Read Galatians 5:17 aloud twice. The war is assumed, not exceptional.

1. Assign honest moments from your week to Galatians 5’s two lists (no names).
2. Does Romans 7 comfort or unsettle you? Why?
3. How does the Spirit use the word to renew a mind (Romans 12:2; John 17:17)?
4. What does “setting the mind” look like concretely this week?

Practice report: Did naming a rising feeling change what happened next, even once?

Prayer: Psalm 139:23–24 together.

Session 4 – The Practice, Part One (Chapters 9–10)

Opening: Walk the five steps on a board before any scripts.

1. Read an anger-at-the-table script. What would two steps have changed in a recent conflict?
2. Which single step is weakest for each person?
3. Role-play: coach the five steps aloud in real time.
4. Which verse from the pocket card do you most need for your frequent trigger?

Practice report: Celebrate one obedience before naming failures.

Prayer: For each person's named trigger.

Session 5 – Habit and Questions (Chapters 11–12)

Opening: Hands: who tried evening examination this week? No judgment — baseline only.

1. What keeps people from starting evening examination?
2. Hebrews 10:24–25 — how can this group motivate love, not only discuss chapters?
3. Wrestle one FAQ from Chapter 12 (especially "Is the goal to feel nothing?").
4. Name one warning sign that practice is becoming cold detachment instead of warmer love.

Practice report: One pattern from the notebook.

Prayer: For one another's homes by name.

Session 6 – Becoming (Chapters 13–14)

Opening: Read Matthew 16:24. Name one ordinary cross from this week.

1. What is the danger of spiritual intensity without daily rhythm?
2. Where has your life shown long obedience in the same direction?
3. Share one sentence of a ninety-day Rule of Life (morning · moment · evening · community).
4. Marcus is "still learning." How does that ending reshape your expectations?

Practice report: What honestly changed from Session 1 to tonight?

Prayer: Named requests for each person. **Schedule a ninety-day check-in in writing before you leave.**

Justified once. Sanctified daily.